

InvestIQ

ETF Universe Reference

Current holdings & candidate expansions with category explanations

What is an ETF?

An **Exchange-Traded Fund (ETF)** is a basket of securities — stocks, bonds, or commodities — that trades on a stock exchange like a single share. ETFs offer instant diversification, low costs, and intraday liquidity. Unlike mutual funds, they can be bought and sold throughout the trading day at market prices.

ETFs are described by two key dimensions in InvestIQ: their **Category** (the broad type of exposure they provide) and their **Market Focus** (the specific segment they track). Together these two dimensions tell you both *what kind* of asset an ETF holds and *which slice* of that market it covers.

ETF Categories

InvestIQ organizes its ETF universe into seven categories. Each represents a fundamentally different type of market exposure with its own risk profile, correlation behavior, and role in a portfolio.

SECTOR

Sector ETFs track a specific slice of the US stock market — one of the 11 official GICS sectors (Technology, Financials, Energy, etc.). They let you overweight or underweight industries you have conviction in. All 11 SPDR Select Sector ETFs are represented, making this group a complete map of the S&P; 500's building blocks.

BROAD MARKET

Broad Market ETFs give diversified exposure to large swaths of the market — the whole US stock market, large-cap indices, international developed markets, emerging markets, bonds, and gold. These are the core building blocks of most investment portfolios and serve as benchmarks for performance.

THEMATIC

Thematic ETFs bet on a specific trend, technology, or cultural shift rather than a traditional sector. Examples include clean energy, cybersecurity, robotics, and video games. They carry higher risk than sector ETFs but offer targeted exposure to high-growth narratives.

FIXED INCOME

Fixed Income ETFs hold bonds — government, corporate, or inflation-protected. They provide income through interest payments and act as a stabilizer in a portfolio, generally moving inversely to equities during risk-off periods. Duration (short vs. long) determines sensitivity to interest rate changes.

INTERNATIONAL

International ETFs provide equity exposure outside the United States — covering developed markets like Japan and Europe, or specific countries like India and China. They add geographic diversification and exposure to different economic cycles, currencies, and growth rates.

COMMODITY

Commodity ETFs track physical goods — oil, silver, agriculture, or a diversified basket. They serve as inflation hedges and portfolio diversifiers, often moving independently from stocks and bonds. Most commodity ETFs use futures contracts rather than holding the physical asset.

FACTOR

Factor ETFs (also called Smart Beta) tilt toward stocks with specific characteristics — value, growth, momentum, or quality — that have historically outperformed the broad market over long periods. They sit between passive index funds and active management, applying rules-based screens to capture a risk premium.

Current ETF Universe (25 ETFs)

Broad Market			
Ticker	Name	Market Focus	Description
SPY	SPDR S&P; 500 ETF Trust	US Large-Cap	The original and most traded ETF in the world. Tracks the S&P; 500 index — 500 of the largest US companies. The gold standard benchmark for US equity performance.
QQQ	Invesco QQQ Trust	US Tech-Heavy Large-Cap	Tracks the Nasdaq-100 — the 100 largest non-financial companies listed on the Nasdaq. Heavily weighted toward technology and growth stocks.
IWM	iShares Russell 2000 ETF	US Small-Cap	Tracks 2,000 small-cap US companies. More domestically focused than large-cap indices. Often used to gauge the health of the broader US economy.
VTI	Vanguard Total Stock Market ETF	US Total Market	Covers the entire US equity market — large, mid, and small-cap stocks. One of the most diversified single-fund options available and has an ultra-low expense ratio.
EFA	iShares MSCI EAFE ETF	International Developed	Tracks stocks in Europe, Australasia, and the Far East (EAFE). Provides broad international developed market exposure excluding the US and Canada.
EEM	iShares MSCI Emerging Markets ETF	Emerging Markets	Covers large and mid-cap stocks across 24 emerging market countries. Top weights include China, India, and Taiwan. Higher growth potential but higher risk than developed markets.
BND	Vanguard Total Bond Market ETF	US Bonds	Tracks the entire US investment-grade bond market — government, corporate, and mortgage-backed securities. The bond equivalent of VTI. Low cost, highly diversified fixed income.
GLD	SPDR Gold Shares	Gold / Commodity	Tracks the price of gold bullion. Acts as an inflation hedge and safe haven during market stress. One of the most widely held commodity ETFs globally.

Sector			
Ticker	Name	Market Focus	Description
XLK	Technology Select Sector SPDR	Technology	Tracks the technology sector of the S&P; 500. Top holdings include Apple, Microsoft, and NVIDIA. The largest and most liquid sector ETF in the universe.
XLF	Financial Select Sector SPDR	Financials	Covers banks, insurance companies, and financial services within the S&P; 500. Sensitive to interest rate movements and economic cycles.
XLE	Energy Select Sector SPDR	Energy	Tracks oil, gas, and energy companies in the S&P; 500. Heavily influenced by crude oil prices and global energy demand.

Ticker	Name	Market Focus	Description
XLV	Health Care Select Sector SPDR	Health Care	Covers pharmaceuticals, biotech, medical devices, and health services. Considered defensive — demand for health care persists across economic cycles.
XLI	Industrial Select Sector SPDR	Industrials	Tracks aerospace, defense, transportation, and industrial manufacturing companies. Often used as a proxy for economic activity and infrastructure spending.
XLB	Materials Select Sector SPDR	Materials	Covers mining, chemicals, and construction materials companies. Tends to perform well during commodity cycles and periods of infrastructure investment.
XLY	Consumer Discretionary Select Sector SPDR	Consumer Discretionary	Tracks non-essential consumer goods and services — retail, autos, restaurants, and leisure. Sensitive to consumer confidence and disposable income.
XLP	Consumer Staples Select Sector SPDR	Consumer Staples	Covers essential goods — food, beverages, household products, and tobacco. Considered defensive because demand remains stable regardless of economic conditions.
XLU	Utilities Select Sector SPDR	Utilities	Tracks electric, gas, and water utilities. Known for stable dividends and low volatility. Sensitive to interest rates — often treated like a bond proxy.
XLRE	Real Estate Select Sector SPDR	Real Estate	Covers REITs (Real Estate Investment Trusts) and real estate companies in the S&P; 500. Provides real estate exposure with stock-market liquidity.
XLC	Communication Services Select Sector SPDR	Communication Services	Tracks telecom, media, and internet companies including Meta, Alphabet, and Netflix. Created in 2018 when telecom and media were separated from Tech.

Thematic

Ticker	Name	Market Focus	Description
ARKK	ARK Innovation ETF	Disruptive Innovation	Actively managed ETF targeting disruptive innovation across AI, genomics, fintech, and robotics. High risk, high reward — known for explosive gains and steep drawdowns.
ICLN	iShares Global Clean Energy ETF	Clean Energy	Tracks global clean energy companies — solar, wind, and other renewables. Highly sensitive to policy changes, energy prices, and ESG investor flows.
CIBR	First Trust Cybersecurity ETF	Cybersecurity	Covers companies providing cybersecurity hardware, software, and services. A structural growth theme as digital threats continue to increase globally.
ROBO	Robo Global Robotics & Automation ETF	Robotics & Automation	Tracks companies involved in robotics, automation, and AI across the full value chain — from component manufacturers to end-use application providers.

Ticker	Name	Market Focus	Description
HERO	Global X Video Games & Esports ETF	Gaming & Esports	Covers video game developers, publishers, and esports companies globally. Benefited from the pandemic gaming boom; now a maturing theme with stable growth.
AWAY	ETFMG Travel Tech ETF	Travel Technology	Tracks companies enabling travel through technology — online booking, ridesharing, and vacation rental platforms. High recovery potential but cyclically sensitive.

Candidate Additions (21 ETFs)

Commodity			
Ticker	Name	Market Focus	Description
SLV	iShares Silver Trust	Silver	Tracks the price of silver bullion. More volatile than gold with additional industrial demand from solar panels and electronics. Acts as both a store of value and industrial metal.
USO	United States Oil Fund	Crude Oil	Tracks the price of West Texas Intermediate (WTI) crude oil via futures. Highly volatile and sensitive to OPEC policy, geopolitical events, and global demand.
DBA	Invesco DB Agriculture Fund	Agriculture	Tracks a basket of agricultural commodity futures — corn, wheat, soybeans, and sugar. An inflation hedge and food security play with low correlation to equities.
PDBC	Invesco Optimum Yield Diversified Commodity ETF	Diversified Commodities	Covers a broad basket of energy, metals, and agricultural futures. Designed to minimize negative roll yield — a common drag on futures-based commodity ETFs.

Factor			
Ticker	Name	Market Focus	Description
VTV	Vanguard Value ETF	Value	Tracks large and mid-cap US stocks with low price-to-book and price-to-earnings ratios. The value factor has historically outperformed over long horizons, especially after growth sell-offs.
VUG	Vanguard Growth ETF	Growth	Tracks large and mid-cap US stocks with high earnings growth expectations. Pairs naturally with VTV as the two poles of the growth-value spectrum.
MTUM	iShares MSCI USA Momentum Factor ETF	Momentum	Tilts toward stocks with strong recent price performance. The momentum factor captures the tendency of recent winners to keep winning over the medium term.
QUAL	iShares MSCI USA Quality Factor ETF	Quality	Focuses on companies with high return on equity, stable earnings, and low leverage. Quality tends to outperform in late-cycle and recessionary environments.

Fixed Income			
Ticker	Name	Market Focus	Description
TLT	iShares 20+ Year Treasury Bond ETF	Long-Term Government Bonds	Tracks US Treasury bonds with maturities over 20 years. Highly sensitive to interest rate changes — moves inversely to rates. A classic recession hedge and portfolio stabilizer.
HYG	iShares iBoxx High Yield Corporate Bond ETF	High Yield (Junk) Bonds	Covers lower-rated corporate bonds with higher yields. Sits between investment-grade bonds and equities in the risk/return spectrum. Sensitive to credit conditions.

Ticker	Name	Market Focus	Description
LQD	iShares iBoxx Investment Grade Corporate Bond ETF	Investment Grade Corp Bonds	Tracks investment-grade corporate bonds. Higher yield than Treasuries with moderate credit risk. Useful for income-focused portfolios.
TIP	iShares TIPS Bond ETF	Inflation-Protected Bonds	Covers Treasury Inflation-Protected Securities (TIPS). Principal adjusts with CPI inflation, making this a natural hedge against rising prices.
SHY	iShares 1-3 Year Treasury Bond ETF	Short-Term Government Bonds	Tracks short-duration US Treasuries. Very low interest rate sensitivity. Used for capital preservation and as a cash-equivalent in risk-off environments.

International			
Ticker	Name	Market Focus	Description
VEU	Vanguard FTSE All-World ex-US ETF	Global ex-US	Tracks the entire world equity market outside the United States — both developed and emerging. The most comprehensive single international ETF available.
EWJ	iShares MSCI Japan ETF	Japan	Covers large and mid-cap Japanese equities. Japan is the third-largest economy and a major tech and automotive hub. Exposure includes yen currency risk.
INDA	iShares MSCI India ETF	India	Tracks Indian equities — one of the world's fastest-growing major economies. High demographic tailwinds and a booming tech sector make this a compelling long-term growth play.
FXI	iShares China Large-Cap ETF	China	Covers the 50 largest Chinese companies listed in Hong Kong. High potential but also high risk from regulatory actions, geopolitics, and currency controls.
VWO	Vanguard FTSE Emerging Markets ETF	Diversified Emerging Markets	Vanguard's version of broad emerging market exposure. Lower cost than EEM with slightly different country weights. A strong competitor to EEM in the universe.

Thematic			
Ticker	Name	Market Focus	Description
BOTZ	Global X Robotics & Artificial Intelligence ETF	Robotics & AI	Covers companies developing or using robotics and AI — a more concentrated AI play than ROBO. Includes industrial robotics, autonomous systems, and AI software firms.
FINX	Global X FinTech ETF	Financial Technology	Tracks fintech companies disrupting traditional financial services — payments, lending, blockchain, and digital banking. High growth but sensitive to rate and regulatory changes.
BITO	ProShares Bitcoin Strategy ETF	Cryptocurrency (Bitcoin)	The first US Bitcoin ETF — holds Bitcoin futures rather than Bitcoin directly. Provides regulated crypto exposure without a separate wallet or exchange account.

All candidate ETFs are available via yfinance and can be added to InvestIQ with no backend changes — just update the ETFs dictionary in `fetch_prices.py` and re-seed. Descriptions are for educational purposes and do not constitute investment advice.